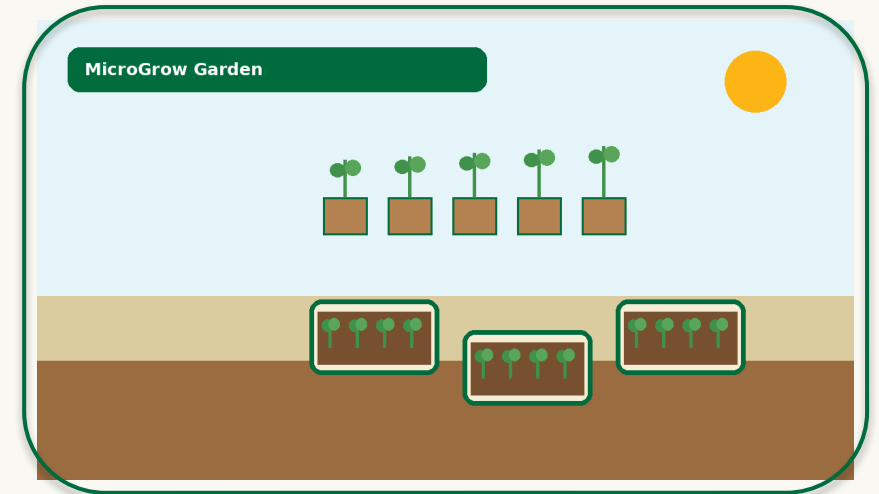


MicroGrow Garden

Discovering How Plants Grow

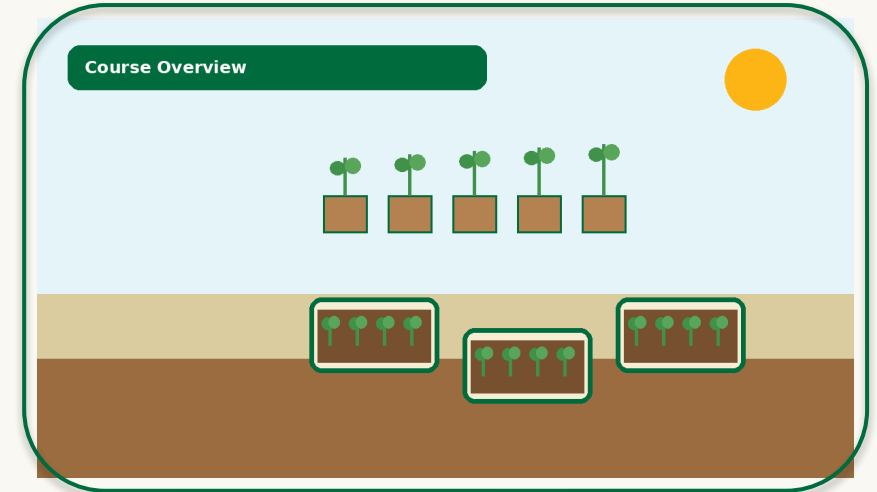
- LIFEWS AgriShine™ GrowMeal™ Nursery Teacher Training
- Audience: Nursery teachers, teaching assistants and garden facilitators
- Format: Self-paced online course + supervised practical orientation
- Recommended duration: 2 hours 30 minutes online + 60 minutes garden practical



Course Overview

Learning outcomes, materials and completion requirements

- By the end of the course, teachers should be able to explain the garden's learning purpose, prepare age-appropriate activities, facilitate the ten course topics, manage children safely outdoors, and document learning through observation.
- Recommended materials: teacher guide; picture/word cards appropriate to the garden; child-safe tools where needed; watering equipment; observation sheets; drawing materials; labels; handwashing supplies; first-aid access.
- Completion: review all modules, complete the practical teacher task, and demonstrate safe supervision of one short garden lesson.



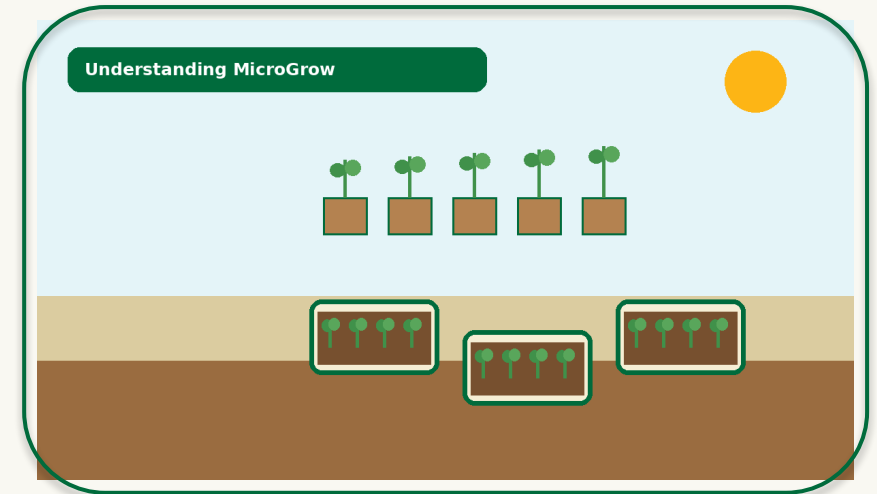
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Training principle: concrete experience first, simple language second, repetition throughout.

Understanding MicroGrow

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- MicroGrow uses small, manageable growing units so children can watch plant development closely.
- Each unit should make change easy to notice without requiring complex equipment.
- Use fast, reliable crops selected by the garden program.
- Keep the focus on sequence and care: seed → sprout → seedling → growing plant.
- Teacher routine: PLANT → WATCH → CARE → COMPARE → TALK.



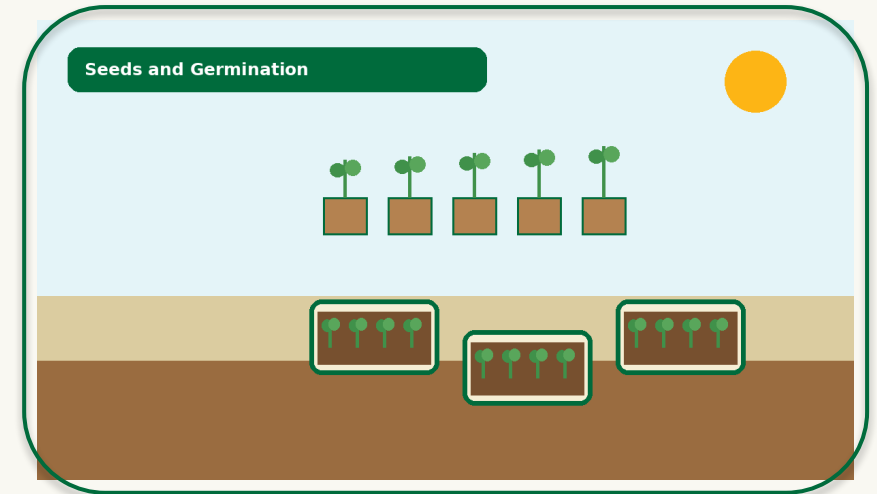
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Select one crop for a short growth-observation cycle.

Seeds and Germination

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Show dry seeds before planting and explain that a new plant can begin from a seed.
- Use large, safe seeds when possible for young children.
- Introduce germination as the seed beginning to grow.
- Use pictures to show changes that occur below the soil when they cannot be seen.
- Avoid opening or digging up planted seeds repeatedly.



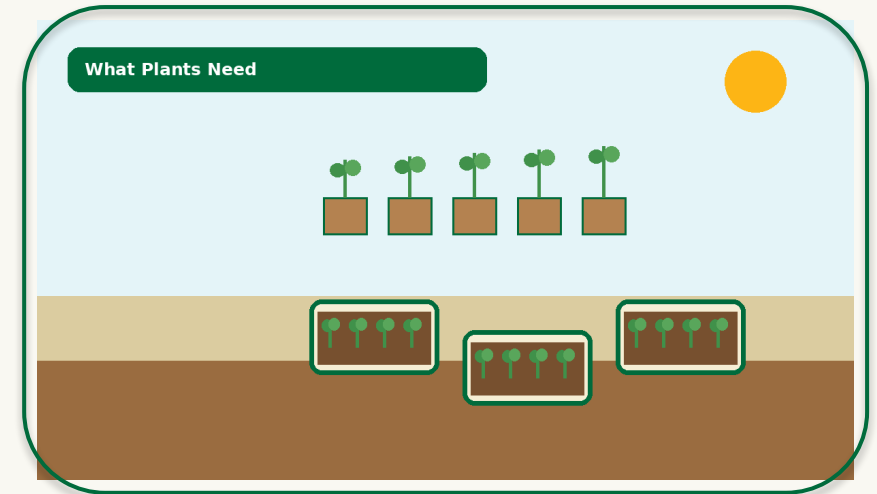
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare seed samples and a simple germination picture sequence.

What Plants Need

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Introduce four essentials in simple language: suitable water, light, air and a place/material for roots to grow.
- Explain that plants need the right amount, not unlimited water or sunlight.
- Use real garden examples to discuss each need.
- Avoid presenting fertilizer as “plant food” without explanation; at Nursery level focus on healthy growing conditions.
- Revisit these needs when plants change.



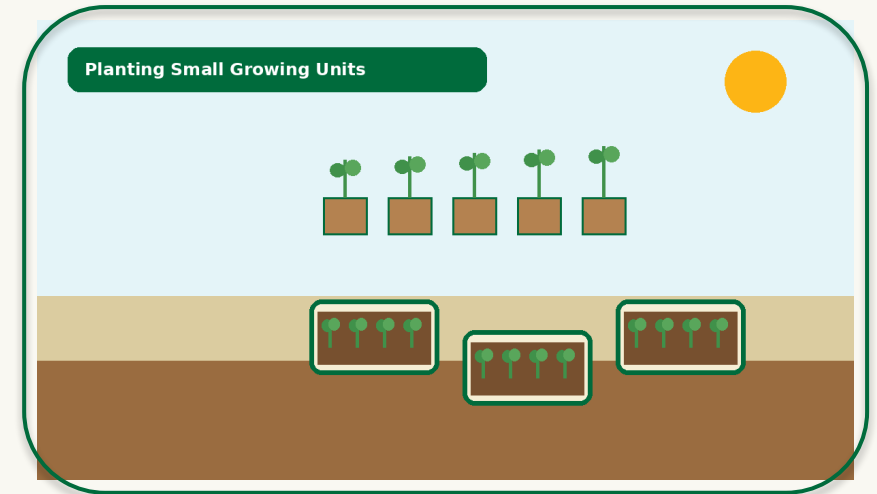
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Create four simple picture cards: water, light, air, growing place.

Planting Small Growing Units

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Prepare clean small pots, cells or approved MicroGrow modules.
- Demonstrate making a planting hole, placing seed/seedling, covering gently and labeling.
- Give one clear task to each child.
- Use appropriate planting depth and spacing for the crop.
- Place units where they can be observed without frequent disturbance.



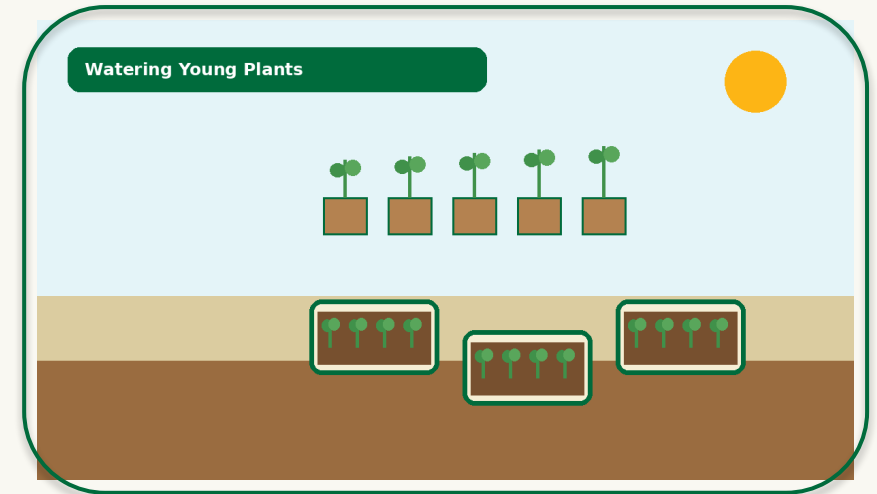
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Pre-stage media, containers, labels and water.

Watering Young Plants

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Use small watering amounts and demonstrate gentle application.
- Check the growing medium before watering rather than watering automatically.
- Avoid washing seeds out of shallow containers.
- Keep trays drained so roots are not left in stagnant water.
- Let children observe the difference between moist and very dry media using teacher-approved examples.



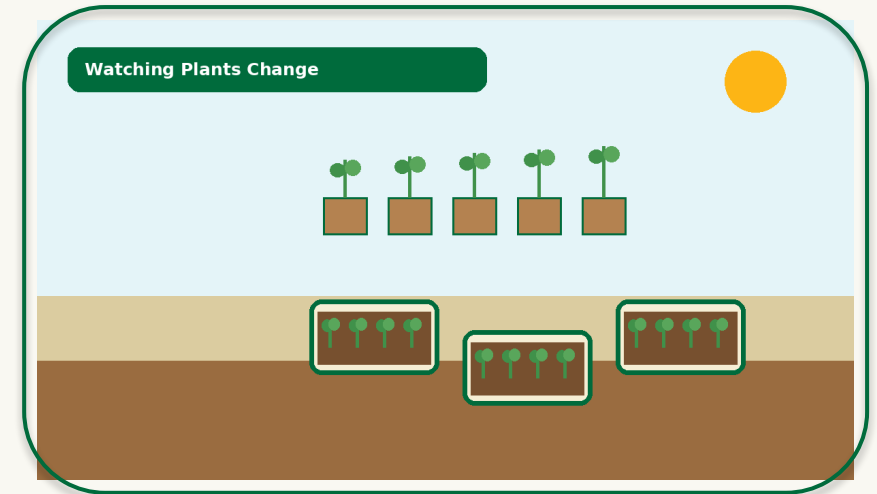
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Teach CHECK → WATER GENTLY → STOP.

Watching Plants Change

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Revisit the same plants on a predictable schedule.
- Look for sprouting, new leaves, height, color and stem changes.
- Use photographs, drawings or a teacher growth strip to document change.
- Ask “What is different today?” before giving explanations.
- Accept that individual plants may grow at different rates.



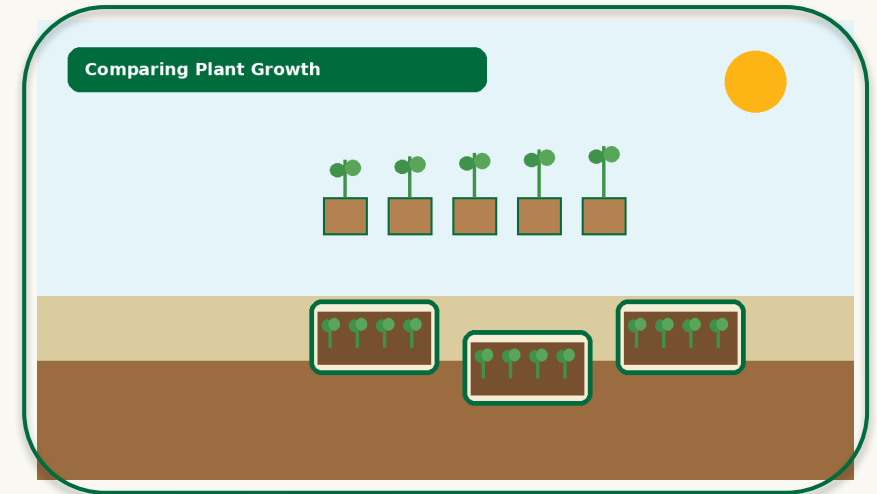
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Choose one fixed weekly observation day.

Comparing Plant Growth

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Compare two healthy plants or groups using simple descriptors: taller/shorter, more/fewer leaves, bigger/smaller.
- Avoid ranking children by whose plant grows fastest.
- Discuss possible reasons carefully without claiming a cause from one observation.
- Keep conditions similar when the goal is simple comparison.
- Use failed germination as an observation opportunity, not a child failure.



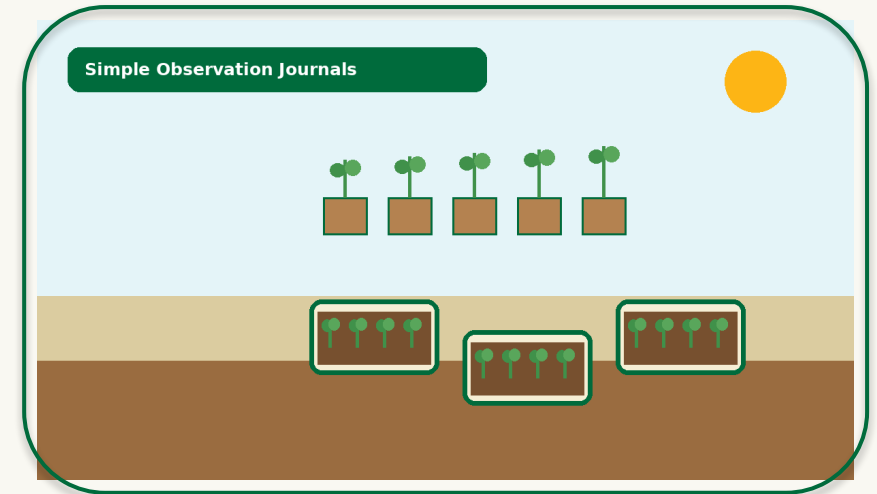
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare one paired comparison with clear visual differences.

Simple Observation Journals

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Use drawing-first journals suitable for early learners.
- Teacher may write the child's spoken observation beside the drawing.
- Include date or visit number to show sequence over time.
- Use one prompt per page: "Draw what you see today."
- Store journals near the garden-learning materials for repeated use.



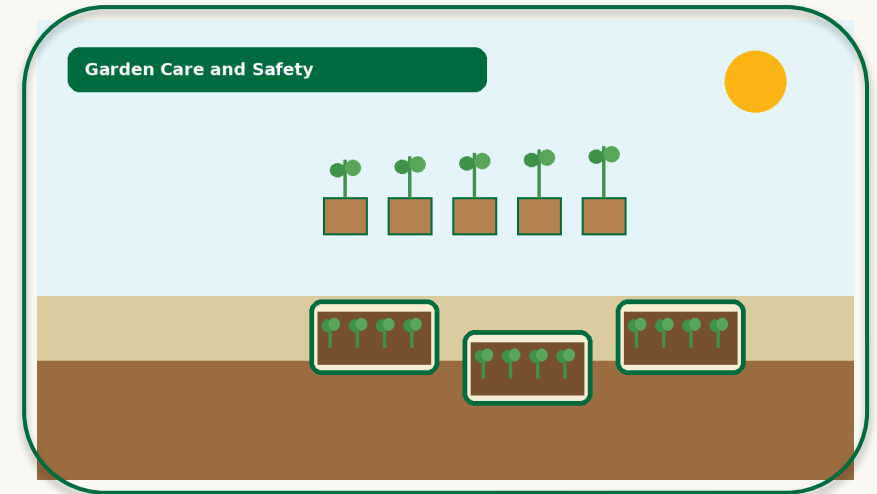
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare a 4-page growth journal template.

Garden Care and Safety

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Use stable containers and child-safe tools.
- Keep water spills cleaned promptly.
- Supervise seeds and small objects according to school age-safety rules.
- Do not allow tasting unless part of an approved food activity.
- Wash hands after soil and plant contact.
- Follow school procedures for allergies, weather and first aid.



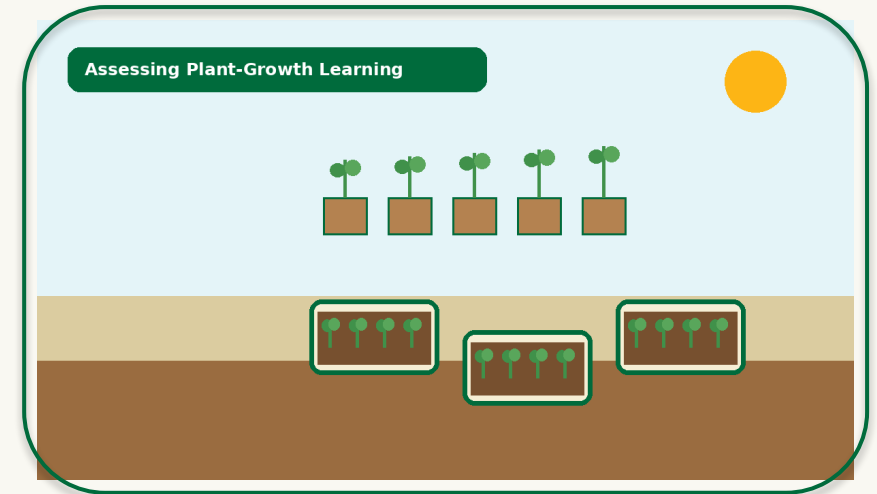
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Check containers, paths, water and tools before each session.

Assessing Plant-Growth Learning

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Look for whether children can identify a seed and plant, state one thing plants need, describe a visible change and participate in basic care.
- Use observation, drawing and short conversation rather than formal testing.
- Record independent vocabulary and sequencing language.
- Compare the child's own earlier and later observations.
- Assess care behaviors as well as factual recognition.



TEACHER PRACTICE

- Completion task: plan a four-visit MicroGrow observation sequence.